Dhruv Patil

Nov 8, 2026 · @D

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Profile

Business analyst and data professional with an MSc in Business Analytics (Distinction) from Newcastle University and a BSc in Data Science from Goa University. I combine analytics training with first-hand frontline experience: at EE I led the product definition and business analysis for BreakPoint, a live break-tracking app now used by my contact-centre team and under consideration for rollout across the Newcastle operation. At M&S I co-built a dashboard and gamified tracker to reduce food waste.

Experienced across the full analytical cycle, from requirements gathering, process mapping and stakeholder engagement to data collection, modelling, dashboards and insight delivery. Hands-on with Power BI, Excel, Python, SQL and Power Query, and with using AI coding tools to turn ideas into working internal tools quickly. I focus on solving real operational problems with simple solutions that people actually want to use.

Core skills

- **Data and technical:** Python (Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, NLP, MILP optimisation), SQL (extraction, transformation, querying), Power BI (dashboards, DAX, data modelling), Power Query, Excel (advanced pivot tables, lookups, data validation, modelling), Tableau, SPSS, Gretl, Git, machine learning, econometric modelling, data warehousing and mining, end-to-end data pipelines
- **Microsoft 365 and Power Platform:** Excel, Power BI, Power Query, Teams, PowerPoint; working knowledge of Power Apps and Power Automate
- **Business analysis:** requirements gathering and documentation, user stories and backlog refinement, process mapping and improvement, current-state analysis, root cause analysis, stakeholder engagement and management, workshop facilitation, KPI definition and performance tracking, business case development
- **Product and change:** product definition and discovery, user-centred design, designing for adoption (engagement and gamification), privacy by design, pilot and impact measurement, digital transformation frameworks (Benefits Dependency Network, Strategic Value Matrix)
- **Strategy and analytics:** PESTEL and strategic analysis, go-to-market strategy, market and sector analysis, demand forecasting, financial modelling, pricing and cost analysis, sentiment analysis, regression and statistical analysis, operational and

marketing analytics, data quality and validation

- **Delivery and collaboration:** Agile/Scrum awareness, project management, cross-functional collaboration, presenting insights to senior stakeholders, AI-assisted development of internal tools

Experience

Sales Guide | EE (BT Group), Newcastle upon Tyne | Jun 2026 – Present

Frontline sales role in an EE contact centre, helping customers choose and set up mobile and broadband services.

- Use EE's sales and account platforms (Consumer.com, Advisor Hub, Galahad) daily, giving first-hand insight into how frontline colleagues and customers experience digital journeys
- Spotted that guides were losing track of break time, and that team leads only saw break data in weekly reports up to two weeks later, too late for fair, timely feedback
- Led product definition and business analysis for **BreakPoint**, a live break-tracking app with separate agent and manager interfaces: defined the problem, requirements, business rules and features, then built it using AI coding tools (see Projects)
- Built it for myself first; my manager asked me to build it for the team, and it is now in use by my 15-person team, with the business asking about a rollout across the Newcastle operation if the pilot succeeds
- Designing a pilot study to measure impact on break overruns, team-lead time and colleague sentiment

Foods A&A Assistant (Part-time) | Marks & Spencer, Newcastle upon Tyne | Dec 2024 – Jun 2026

- Co-Built a live performance dashboard to track colleague completion of date-expired food checks, using real store data to make results visible and fair
- further Co-Designed a gamification concept, with leaderboards and streak rewards, to motivate colleagues on reducing food waste
- Delivered warm, personalised front-line service on a busy food floor, including tills, cash, card payments and refunds
- Worked flexibly across shop floor, stock replenishment, deliveries and housekeeping, keeping areas clean, stocked and presented to brand standards
- Stayed reliable and punctual through peak trading periods

Business Analyst (Volunteer) | GDP Foundation (NGO), Remote | Feb 2025 – Jan 2026

Unpaid, project-based work alongside my MSc. Promoted from Data Analyst Intern.

- Took ownership of requirements gathering and documentation, turning business needs into structured briefs, analytical briefs and process maps for delivery teams
- Analysed current-state processes to find root causes of inefficiency, and redesigned delivery to address causes rather than symptoms
- Led stakeholder discussions across teams to clarify requirements, challenge assumptions, and agree priorities and success criteria
- Led development of KPI frameworks and performance dashboards, making sure metrics were meaningful, validated and aligned to goals
- Contributed to backlog refinement and prioritisation within iterative delivery cycles, working alongside senior team members
- Maintained data quality standards so all outputs were reliable and fit for purpose
- Contributed analysis to a national research study later recognised by NITI Aayog, the Government of India's central policy think tank

Data Analyst Intern | GDP Foundation (NGO), Remote | Sep 2024 – Feb 2025

Unpaid, project-based internship alongside my MSc.

- Analysed data on older adults to identify trends that informed the foundation's strategic planning and decisions
- Analysed operational datasets using Python and SQL to find performance trends and improvement opportunities
- Gathered reporting requirements with cross-functional teams and improved data collection workflows
- Built and maintained KPI tracking dashboards, with rigorous quality checks for accuracy and consistency
- Supported exploratory data analysis and presented findings in structured, stakeholder-facing formats
- Managed multiple reporting deadlines at once while staying organised and accurate

Freelance Business Analyst | Visionize Consultancy, Remote | Aug 2024 – Jan 2026

Project-based freelance work with small businesses.

- Worked directly with clients to elicit, challenge and document business and analytical requirements, turning ambiguous problems into structured solutions
- Built interactive Power BI dashboards and reports to visualise client data, surfacing trends, risks and opportunities
- Built an end-to-end data pipeline from scratch for one client, collecting, cleaning and transforming data from multiple sources using Python, SQL and Power Query
- Produced marketing strategies and market insights tailored to each client's growth goals, monitoring sector trends, demand patterns and competitors

- Contributed to pricing, cost and economic analysis to help clients understand their commercial positioning
- Presented findings to clients in structured sessions, bridging technical outputs and business decisions
- Kept clear process documentation so outputs were traceable, auditable and repeatable

Projects

BreakPoint: live break tracker for a contact-centre team | EE (BT Group) | 2026

- **Problem:** guides get one hour of breaks a day (a 30-minute lunch and two 15-minute breaks) but take them differently and lose track; small overruns add up, and managers only saw break data weeks later
- **Agent view:** one bar per break, a live countdown with friendly nudges, a shift clock, and one shared daily allowance so running over one break borrows from the others (fairer than judging each break separately)
- **Manager view:** a live dashboard with filters (on break, running over, no break yet, not clocked in), a plain-English team summary, minute adjustments, shift and break editing, an uneditable change history, and a 14-day spreadsheet export
- **Adoption:** "Breakathon", a weekly game that rewards staying within break time, so colleagues see the tool as support rather than monitoring
- **Privacy and governance:** pseudonymised user codes, no free-text reason fields, automatic 14-day data retention
- **Delivery:** defined all requirements and rules; built with AI coding tools; moved to a mobile web app after the corporate network blocked the first version

Digital Transformation Strategy, Blueline Mobility | Newcastle University

Designed a digital transformation strategy for Blueline, a major taxi provider in North East England. After stakeholder discussions, proposed an app with smart shift scheduling, real-time routing and loyalty rewards. Used Benefits Dependency Network and Strategic Value Matrix frameworks to map features to measurable business outcomes, with a go-to-market plan and KPI structure.

MSc Dissertation: Emotional Expressiveness and Engagement in Virtual Influencers | Newcastle University | 2025

Mixed-methods study combining computational emotion modelling with user perception surveys on virtual influencer engagement in India. Found that emotional intensity mattered more than the specific emotion, that computational and human perception only

moderately aligned, and that engagement followed a U-shaped pattern rather than growing steadily.

EV Infrastructure and Market Strategy | Newcastle University

Market entry report for Renault, Nissan and Jeep on India's EV landscape, using real sales data, sentiment analysis and financial modelling to assess demand, localisation and investment. Defined key metrics (CAPEX, ROI, demand forecasts) and built stakeholder-facing dashboards.

Last-Mile Delivery Optimisation for Quick Commerce | Newcastle University

Built a Mixed-Integer Linear Programming (MILP) model in Python to optimise 15-minute delivery zones from dark stores in semi-urban India, with constraints for traffic, rider capacity and rurality.

Power BI Dashboard: Energy and Operational Data | Personal project

End-to-end BI solution on large public energy datasets: data cleaning in Power Query, modelling in Power BI, and trend and anomaly analysis.

BSc Dissertation: Twitter Sentiment Analysis for Goa Tourism Policy | Goa University | 2024

Analysed 15,000+ tweets with the RoBERTa model (about 85% accuracy) and used the GPT API to generate policy recommendations for addressing negative sentiment.

Business Analysis: Putzmeister (2015–2023) | Goa University

Eight-year business analysis covering trends, growth, PESTEL and strategic positioning; presented recommendations directly to Putzmeister's Managing Director.

Business Analysis: VDA Infosolutions and the Indian IT Sector | Goa University

Combined sector research with firm-level analysis; presented strategic recommendations directly to the company's founder.

Econometric Analysis: Inflation and GDP Growth | Goa University

Regression model in Gretl analysing the relationship between inflation and GDP growth, tested through hypothesis testing and residual analysis.

UK Manufacturing Employment Dynamics (1976–1984) | Goa University

Econometric model using the Arellano-Bond estimator to analyse how wages and capital investment affected employment across UK manufacturing firms.

Motor Fare: E-Bike Taxi Startup Concept | Goa University

End-to-end startup simulation covering market research, business model, go-to-market strategy and feasibility.

Education

MSc Business Analytics (Distinction) | Newcastle University | Sep 2024 – Sep 2025

- **Modules:** Business Visualisation, Advanced Statistics, Project Management, AI in Business, Marketing Analytics, Operational Analytics, Data-Driven Decision Making, Business Modelling, Stakeholder Management
- **Dissertation:** Exploring Emotional Expressiveness and Engagement in Virtual Influencers: a mixed-methods comparison of computational models and user perceptions in India

BSc Data Science | Goa University | Sep 2021 – May 2024 | CGPA 8.5

- **Modules:** Python, Algorithms and Data Structures, Database Management Systems (SQL), Machine Learning, Probability and Statistics, Econometrics, Linear Programming and Optimisation, Data Warehousing and Mining, Big Data and Frameworks, Business Analytics, Micro and Macroeconomics, Strategic Management, Computer Organisation and Operating Systems, C++
- **Dissertation:** Analysing Twitter Data to Inform and Enhance Policy for Goa's Tourism Industry, using RoBERTa and the GPT API

Certifications and courses

- Advanced Excel Data Visualization (NASBA)
- Microsoft 365 Excel Essential Training (NASBA)
- Data Analytics and Visualization Job Simulation (Accenture North America, Forage)
- Business Fundamentals and Developments (Udemy)
- Basics of Exploratory Data Analysis (Great Learning)
- NCL+ Advanced Award: Campaigning for Social Change (Newcastle University)

Achievements and responsibilities

- **Student Engagement Assistant, Newcastle University:** supported faculty–student communication, handled queries and contributed to improving the student experience
- **Account Manager, College ACM chapter, Goa University:** managed financial records and funds for student initiatives, coordinated team delivery and kept accounts accurate
- **NCL+ Advanced Award:** trained in community leadership, grassroots advocacy and structured communication for social impact